



## Personal Survival Techniques (PST)

### 60 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

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## Practice Set 1

**Q1. Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon (EPIRB) is considered as:**

- A) Primary means of alerting device
- B) Secondary means of alerting device
- C) Both primary and secondary
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: B (Secondary means of alerting device)**

**Q2. How can a Search and Rescue Radar Transponder (SART) effective range be maximized?**

- A) The SART should be placed in water immediately after activation
- B) The SART should be put on high power mode
- C) Mount the SART horizontally with respect to rescue vessel radar
- D) It should be as high as possible

**Correct Answer: D (It should be as high as possible)**

**Q3. On a passenger ship, muster of passengers must be carried out:**

- A) Within one week after boarding the person
- B) Within 24 hours of leaving the port
- C) Whenever the passengers are settled out
- D) Anytime by surprise as decided by the master

**Correct Answer: B (Within 24 hours of leaving the port)**

**Q4. The Thermal Protective Aid (TPA) should permit the wearer to remove it in the water:**

- A) Not more than two minutes
- B) Not more than five minutes
- C) Not more than 10 minutes
- D) Not more than 15 minutes

**Correct Answer: A (Not more than two minutes)**

Q5. Which channel is designated as the VHF follow-on Communication channel required in all portable survival craft equipment?



- A) Channel 06
- B) Channel 70
- C) Channel 13
- D) Channel 16

**Correct Answer: D (Channel 16)**

Q6. How many survival craft VHF walkie-talkies are required to be carried on cargo ships above 500 Gross Registered Tonnage (GRT)?

- A) Two numbers
- B) Three numbers
- C) Four numbers
- D) Five numbers

**Correct Answer: B (Three numbers)**

Q7. You are at sea in an inflatable life raft in high altitudes, the greatest danger is:

- A) Collapse of the raft due to cold temperatures
- B) Asphyxiation due to keeping the canopy closed
- C) Hypothermia caused by cold temperature
- D) Starvation

**Correct Answer: C (Hypothermia caused by cold temperature)**

Q8. Prior to lowering the lifeboat, the most important item to check is:

- A) Oars
- B) Sail
- C) Boat plug
- D) Life preservers

**Correct Answer: C (Boat plug)**

Q9. You are on a survival craft broadcasting a distress message. What information is essential for rescuers?

- A) Nature of distress
- B) Time of the day
- C) Your radio call sign
- D) Your position by latitude and longitude

**Correct Answer: D (Your position by latitude and longitude)**

Q10. What is the type of battery used for EPIRB and your SART?

- A) Lead acid battery
- B) Solar rechargeable cells
- C) Lithium non-rechargeable
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: C (Lithium non-rechargeable)**



- A) Locating signals are transmitted by survival craft VHF transceivers
- B) Locating signals are transmitted by search and rescue radar transponders
- C) Locating signals are intended to facilitate the finding of distress vessel or survivors
- D) Locating signals are not transmitted by auto alarm generators

**Correct Answer: A (Locating signals are transmitted by survival craft VHF transceivers)**

**Q12. The person aboard a vessel signaling by raising and lowering his or her outstretched arms to each side is indicating:**

- A) Danger, stay away
- B) All is clear, it is safe to pass
- C) All is clear, it is safe to approach
- D) A distress signal

**Correct Answer: D (A distress signal)**

**Q13. You are involved in an emergency landing of a helicopter in water. You should inflate your life jacket:**

- A) Upon entering the helicopter
- B) Prior to reaching the water
- C) After reaching the water but prior to exiting the helicopter
- D) After clear of the helicopter

**Correct Answer: D (After clear of the helicopter)**

**Q14. Choose the right combination of VHF channels for emergency communication during search and rescue for ship-to-ship and ship-to-aircraft communication:**

- A) Channel 21 and 23
- B) Channel 06 and 30
- C) Channel 16 and 06
- D) Channel 70 and 16

**Correct Answer: C (Channel 16 and 06)**

**Q15. Davit-launched life raft can be boarded:**

- A) From the water only
- B) At the deck
- C) By jumping down onto it
- D) Through the escape tube

**Correct Answer: B (At the deck)**

**Q16. Cargo ships of 100 meters and above but less than 150 meters should have how many life buoys?**

- A) 8
- B) 12
- C) 30
- D) 14

**Correct Answer: C (30)**



- A) S-band radar
- B) Digital selective calling (DSC) receiver
- C) Satellite communication terminals
- D) X-band radar

**Correct Answer: D (X-band radar)**

**Q18. With a sprinkler system and air system on and all hatches shut, the survival craft will provide protection from:**

- A) Nuclear environment
- B) Fire and toxic environment
- C) Storm or a hurricane
- D) Sea creatures

**Correct Answer: B (Fire and toxic environment)**

**Q19. What must be the characteristics of a lifebuoy attached with a self-igniting light and smoke?**

- A) Two hours of light with two candle luminous intensity with 15 minutes of smoke
- B) One hour of light with 15 minutes of smoke
- C) Two hours of light with two hours of smoke
- D) 15 minutes of light with 15 minutes of smoke

**Correct Answer: A (Two hours of light with two candle luminous intensity with 15 minutes of smoke)**

**Q20. The most important reason for taking anti-seasickness pills as soon as possible after entering into a life raft is to:**

- A) Assist in sleeping
- B) Reduce appetite by decreasing nausea
- C) Prevent loss of body moisture by vomiting
- D) Prevent impact judgment due to motion-induced deliriousness

**Correct Answer: C (Prevent loss of body moisture by vomiting)**

**Q21. The rescue vessel is approaching an activated SART at a distance of five miles. What indication appears on the rescue vessel radar screen?**

- A) SOS symbol appears on the display of the radar screen
- B) Concentric circles
- C) A series of 12 equally spaced blips outward from the SART's position along its line of bearing
- D) Wide arcs

**Correct Answer: C (A series of 12 equally spaced blips outward from the SART's position along its line of bearing)**

**Q22. On what frequency do EPIRBs transmit information to satellites on emergency activation?**

- A) 121.5 MHz
- B) 243 MHz
- C) 156.8 MHz
- D) 406 MHz

**Correct Answer: D (406 MHz)**

Q23. What is the biggest danger to life when your vessel has collided with another ship?

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- A) Oil pollution
- B) Building of compartments
- C) Damage to the ship
- D) Possibility of capsizing

**Correct Answer: D (Possibility of capsizing)**

Q24. What should be the duration and luminous intensity of a hand flare?

- A) 60 seconds with 30,000 candles
- B) 60 seconds with 15,000 candles
- C) 120 seconds with 30,000 candles
- D) 120 seconds with 15,000 candles

**Correct Answer: B (60 seconds with 15,000 candles)**

Q25. One of the main characteristics of a life jacket is:

- A) To swim
- B) To maintain the face of an unconscious person above the water level
- C) To float
- D) All of the above

**Correct Answer: B (To maintain the face of an unconscious person above the water level)**

Q26. Crew duties to passengers in an emergency especially in a passenger vessel involve:

- A) Warn all passengers
- B) Keeping the movement of the passengers towards the muster station
- C) Seeing that they have suitably donned the life jackets in a correct manner
- D) All of the above

**Correct Answer: D (All of the above)**

Q27. What indication does an EPIRB give on activation?

- A) Voice prompt saying EPIRB is activated
- B) Strobe lights or flashes on top of the EPIRB
- C) Gives out a printout of distress message sent
- D) All of the above

**Correct Answer: B (Strobe lights or flashes on top of the EPIRB)**

Q28. How many buoyant orange smoke floats should be kept on the bridge of a vessel?

- A) Two
- B) Four
- C) Six
- D) None

**Correct Answer: D (None)**



- A) Whistle and light
- B) Reflective tape
- C) Whistle, reflective tape, and a light
- D) Only a whistle

**Correct Answer: C (Whistle, reflective tape, and a light)**

**Q30. How do you know how many persons a lifeboat can accommodate?**

- A) Ask your chief officer
- B) No limitations, you can put maximum persons inside
- C) Number of persons it can hold is clearly marked on the outside of the lifeboat
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: C (Number of persons it can hold is clearly marked on the outside of the lifeboat)**

## Practice Set 2

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**Q1. The number of lifebuoys on ship is dependent on:**

- A) What owners provide
- B) Minimum of 10
- C) Minimum of 15
- D) Length of the vessel

**Correct Answer: D (Length of the vessel)**

**Q2. EPIRB stands for:**

- A) Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon
- B) Emergency Position Indicating Radar Beacon
- C) Escape Position Indicating Radar Beacon
- D) Escape Position Indicating Radio Beacon

**Correct Answer: A (Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon)**

**Q3. Which of the following requirements for Immersion suit is correct?**

- A) Donned within 2 minutes
- B) Allow the wearer to jump from 4.5m
- C) Allow the wearer to climb a vertical ladder of 5mtrs
- D) All of the above

**Correct Answer: D (All of the above)**

**Q4. How much faster does the human body lose heat in the water?**

- A) 10
- B) 20
- C) 26
- D) 36

**Correct Answer: C (26)**

Q5. When person floating in the water in group, they should be in:



- A) Help position
- B) Huddle position
- C) Yoga position
- D) None of the above

**Correct Answer: B (Huddle position)**

Q6. How should the painter of a liferaft which is fitted with hydrostatic release unit be secured to the ship?

- A) Secured via weak link to a secured point on the ship
- B) Secured to the part of hydrostatic release that is designed to break free
- C) It should not be secured anyway
- D) Directly to a secure point on the ship

**Correct Answer: A (Secured via weak link to a secured point on the ship)**

Q7. LTA is used as:

- A) Messenger line
- B) Heaving line
- C) Mooring Line
- D) Lashing line

**Correct Answer: A (Messenger line)**

Q8. Life jacket light shall be capable of providing luminous intensity of \_\_\_\_\_ for a period of \_\_\_\_\_:

- A) .75cd/8hrs
- B) .50cd/8hrs
- C) .75cd/6hrs
- D) .50cd/6hrs

**Correct Answer: A (.75cd/8hrs)**

Q9. Lifeboat must be stowed in such a way that they can be launched in \_\_\_\_\_ mins:

- A) 10 mins
- B) 15 mins
- C) 20 mins
- D) 05 mins

**Correct Answer: A (10 mins)**

Q10. A distress signal on deck:

- A) Pyrotechnics
- B) Open fire
- C) NC Flag
- D) All of the above

**Correct Answer: D (All of the above)**



- A) Search and Rescue Radar Transponder
- B) Search and Rescue Radar Transformer
- C) Search and Rescue Radar Transmission
- D) Search and Rescue Radar Transmisor

**Correct Answer: A (Search and Rescue Radar Transponder)**

**Q12. Your vessel has been in collision and you are not sure if your vessel is sinking or not, How will you handle this situation?**

- A) Make sure that the lifeboat has as much fuel as possible and make your course for nearest land
- B) Wait and see how the situation is developing
- C) Search for missing person, continue to monitor the situation and prepare for event management in case it becomes necessary
- D) Leave the vessel and stay not closer than 5 NM

**Correct Answer: C (Search for missing person, continue to monitor the situation and prepare for event management in case it becomes necessary)**

**Q13. What is a fire wire?**

- A) Wire for pulling burning ships off the pier
- B) Wire for handling fire bucket
- C) Wire for pulling fire hoses upto the top bridge
- D) Wire for securing smoke divers

**Correct Answer: A (Wire for pulling burning ships off the pier)**

**Q14. Quantity of water in lifeboat per person:**

- A) 3Ltrs
- B) 5Ltrs
- C) 4Ltrs
- D) 2Ltrs

**Correct Answer: A (3Ltrs)**

**Q15. How many servival craft walkie talkie required as per SOLAS for a ship of more than 500GT?**

- A) 2
- B) 3
- C) 5
- D) 1

**Correct Answer: A (2)**

**Q16. Quantity of water in Life raft per person:**

- A) 1.5 Ltrs
- B) 2 Ltrs
- C) 3 Ltrs
- D) 2.5 Ltrs

**Correct Answer: A (1.5 Ltrs)**



- A) The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to give additional insulation from the cold
- B) The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to help insulation in addition to the TPA
- C) TPA for each person
- D) At least 10% or 2 TPA of the total crew

**Correct Answer: B (The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to help insulation in addition to the TPA)**

Q18. Which of the listed requirements do not corresponds to present regulation the life raft shall have:

- A) Manually controlled lamp visible of at least two miles fitted at the top of the canopy
- B) All entrances fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding the life raft
- C) Floor preventing the ingress of water
- D) Manually controlled lamp fitted inside the liferaft

**Correct Answer: B (All entrances fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding the life raft)**

Q19. In free fall Lifeboat, instead of Immersion suit TPA is provided for all persons:

- A) True
- B) False

**Correct Answer: B (False)**

Q20. Your vessel have been in collision with another vessel, you are taking in water and you have to prepare for leaving the vessel. How will you act?

- A) Just jump overboard and be ready
- B) Collect your own personal belongings
- C) Assist your friends to collect their personal belonging
- D) Send a distress message and collect survival suits/Thermal bags

**Correct Answer: D (Send a distress message and collect survival suits/Thermal bags)**

Q21. Which one of the listed requirements regarding the stowage of a survival craft corresponds to present SOLAS regulations? Each survival craft shall be stowed:

- A) Wherever space is available
- B) In a state of readiness so that two crew members can prepare
- C) On the starboard side of the ship
- D) In a secure and sheltered position and protected from damage by fire and explosion

**Correct Answer: B (In a state of readiness so that two crew members can prepare)**

Q22. Which one of the listed requirements regarding LSA do not corresponds to present regulations?

- A) All prescribed LSA shall be made of non-combustible or fire retardant material
- B) All prescribed LSA shall be of a highly visible colour
- C) All prescribed LSA shall be fitted with a retro reflective material which will assist in detection
- D) All prescribed LSA shall be resistant to deterioration where exposed to sunlight

**Correct Answer: A (All prescribed LSA shall be made of non-combustible or fire retardant material)**

Q23. Which one of the listed requirements regarding launching appliances for survival craft and rescue boats not corresponds to present regulation?



- A) Parts requiring regular maintenance by ships crew shall be readily accessible
- B) The launching mechanism shall be arranged for actuating from a position within the survival craft or rescue boat in addition to a position on the ships deck
- C) All launching appliances shall be capable of recovering survival craft and rescue boats with their crew
- D) Launching appliances shall be constructed for minimum amount of routine maintainance

**Correct Answer: C (All launching appliances shall be capable of recovering survival craft and rescue boats with their crew)**

Q24. Maximum carrying capacity of a lifeboat:

- A) 100 Persons
- B) 150 Persons
- C) 50 Persons
- D) 25 Persons

**Correct Answer: B (150 Persons)**

Q25. An Immersion suit shall permit the person wearing it:

- A) Climb up and down a vertical ladder of atleast 5m in length
- B) Perform normal duties associated with abandoning ship
- C) Jump from a height of not less than 4.5m
- D) All of the above

**Correct Answer: D (All of the above)**

Q26. Checking and servicing life rafts as per PMS is:

- A) Once a year
- B) Twice a year
- C) Once in 5 years
- D) Based on condition of Liferaft

**Correct Answer: A (Once a year)**

Q27. Before lifting a Lifeboat from water it should be ensured that:

- A) Bottom plug is secured tight
- B) Falls wires are clear and secured tightly
- C) Engine is going astern
- D) Sea anchor is streamed

**Correct Answer: B (Falls wires are clear and secured tightly)**

Q28. Which one of the routine test and inspection of LSA is not required by regulations:

- A) Lifeboat engine should be run for atleast 3 mins every week
- B) General emergency alarm to be tested daily
- C) Survival craft and Rescue boats with launching appliances shall be visually inspected weekly
- D) Inspection of Lifeboat equipments shall be carried out monthly

**Correct Answer: B (General emergency alarm to be tested daily)**



- A) Substitute for limit switch of gravity davits
- B) To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks
- C) For releasing life raft in bad weather
- D) For releasing lifeboat from sinking vessel

**Correct Answer: B (To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks)**

**Q30. Lifeboat should have:**

- A) 2 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line
- B) 2 buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 15mtrs buoyant line
- C) 1 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line
- D) 1 buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 15mtrs buoyant line

**Correct Answer: A (2 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line)**